

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 7 Handout — Epic to Task is a planning graph. WIP limits keep the board honest.

1 - Azure & DevOps Foundations · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — Agile process work item graph

Type	Parent / child	This series example
Epic	Top of the tree	100 Days Learning
Feature	Child of Epic	Phase 1 Foundations
User Story	Child of Feature; AB# links to PRs later	Explore Azure Test Plans
Task	Child of Story; hours optional	Create test plan, add 2 cases
Bug	Can hang off Story or backlog	Use when a lab step actually fails
Issue (Agile)	Impediment, not a delivery item	Skip unless blocked on SKU/trial
States	New → Active → Resolved → Closed (Agile)	Board maps these to To Do / Doing / Done

Architecture B — backlog vs board vs query

Surface	Job	Use it when
Backlog	Ordered list; drag rank	Planning what might ship this phase
Board	Columns = state; cards = stories	Seeing WIP right now
Sprint / Iteration	Timebox + capacity	Optional for a 1-person lab
Query	WIQL filter saved	Work Item Type = User Story AND State <> Closed
Dashboard widget	Chart from a query	Day 10 Phase 1 Command Center
WIP limit	Column policy on Doing	Doing > 3 on a solo lab is theatre

Architecture C — pitfalls that turn Boards into sticky-note chaos

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
No hierarchy	50 stories, zero Features	Epic → Feature → Story before more cards
Everything in Doing	Board is a parking lot	Set WIP on Doing; finish or uncommit
Query = Excel export	Stale CSV in Downloads	Save shared query in azure-100-labs
Closing without moving	State Closed, board still Doing	Move the card; do not only edit State in the form
Work items in the wrong Area	Default area vs team backlog empty	Project settings → Teams → Area paths
Linking later 'when we have Git'	Phase 2 PRs with no AB#	Create stories now; link PRs from Day 14

One-liner to remember

Boards without WIP limits are sticky-note chaos with better fonts — limit Doing or the board owns you.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Project azure-100-labs. Personal org only. Agile process from Day 6.

- 1 Boards → Work items → New Work Item → Epic → Title 100 Days Learning → Save. Note the ID.
- 2 New Feature Phase 1 Foundations → Add link → Parent → the Epic. Save.
- 3 Create 3 User Stories as children of the Feature: Explore Azure Test Plans; Create Azure Artifacts feed; Stand up end-to-end mini project.
- 4 Boards → Boards → drag one story New/To Do → Active/Doing → Closed/Done. Watch the column counts.
- 5 Board settings (gear) → Columns → Doing → WIP limit 3. Save.
- 6 Boards → Queries → New query → Work Item Type = User Story AND State <> Closed → Save as Open stories.
- 7 Open one story → Related Work. You will link a PR here in Phase 2. Do not invent fake employer sprints.

Optional Azure Boards CLI — create a story with a parent Feature

```
az boards query --wiql "SELECT [System.Id], [System.Title], [System.State] FROM WorkItems WHERE [System.WorkItemType] = 'User Story' AND [System.State] <> 'Closed'" -o table
# Create (IDs will differ):
# az boards work-item create --type "User Story" --title "Explore Azure Test Plans" --project azure-100-labs
```

Done checklist

- Can explain Epic → Feature → User Story → Task
- Hierarchy exists in azure-100-labs
- One story moved to Done on the board; WIP set on Doing
- Saved query: User Story AND State <> Closed

Tomorrow — Day 8

Azure Test Plans basics